



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER  
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC  
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE  
Feb 2023

#2

## COMING EVENTS

### FEBRUARY

- 2nd Monthly Meeting
- 4th Central Coast W'shop
- 5th Presentation Lunch
- 7th OASIS Run Mooney
- 8th Committee Meeting

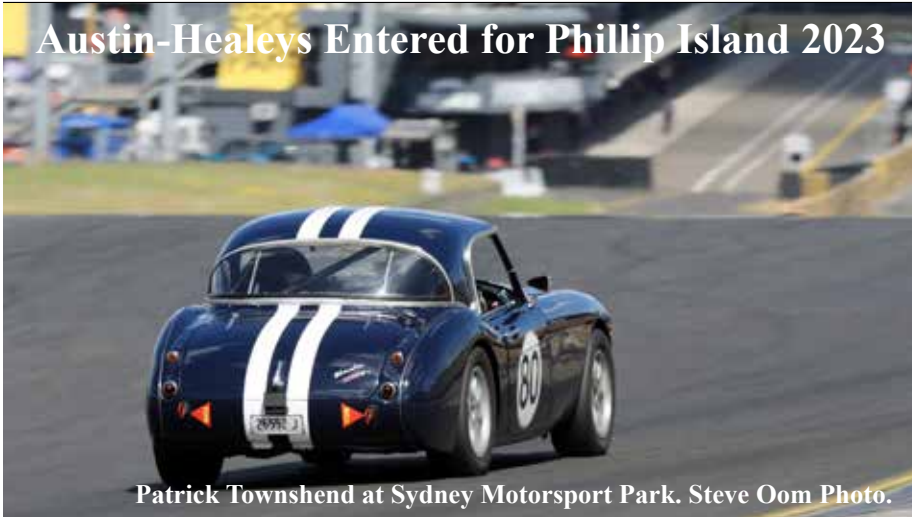
### MARCH

- 2nd Monthly Meeting
- 4th Central Coast W'shop
- 8th Committee Meeting
- 11th Sydney Workshop
- 18th Fish & Chip Run

## IN THIS ISSUE

- P1.... AHs at Phillip Island
- P2..President's Message/C'itee
- P3..... Editorial
- P4..... Reports
- P8 .... Painted Silos Itinerary
- P10 ... Memories
- P13 ... National Rally
- P17 ... Red Engines
- P20 ... Those were the Days
- P16 ... Healey Abbott Sold
- P25 ... For Sale
- P26 ... Trip to Calder - 1974
- P32 ... 100 Windscreen Seal
- P31 ... Your Last Page

## Austin-Healeys Entered for Phillip Island 2023



Patrick Townshend at Sydney Motorsport Park. Steve Oom Photo.

Organised by the Victorian Historic Racing Register, this year's Phillip Island Classic will be held on March 9-12 and once again promises to be a great weekend of Historic Motorsport.

Of interest to us is that there are two of our members who have entered for the meeting namely Patrick Townshend and Chris Komor. Patrick is running his 3000 Mk1 that he purchased from Colin Goldsmith and Chris has entered his 100 BN1 that he has been campaigning for the last few years.

Other Austin-Healeys include the

100/6 of ex-member Zach McAfee, Becher Thownsend's 100/6 (Tasmania based, Becher is Patrick's brother and car is ex-Brian Duffy) and the 3000 Mk1 of Peter Jackson (Peter is an AHOC Vic member and past NSW member).

All have entered is what's called Group Sa which is for production sports cars, manufactured between 1st January 1941 and 31st December 1960.

If the thought of racing Austin-Healeys appeals, Phillip Island will truly be the place to be over the second weekend of March.



Chris Komor at Phillip Island. Neil Hammond Photo.



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FB: [www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/](https://www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/)

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

# PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

The 2023 Club year officially starts now. You have had an opportunity to spend time with family and friends and I hope that was a great time of relaxing and catching up. The grandkids are back at school or university and it's time to get back to normal.

This week is our first face to face meeting on Thursday; the first chapter workshop for Central Coast members (and others who need an excuse to get their cars out on the road) and the first official social event at Julie and Garry Lee's place at Niagara Park. I'm hoping that for most of you I will be able to see you at least two of those events. However please make sure that your name is down for the Presentation Lunch, so that you will be fed.

Also, as mentioned last month, we will be awarding trophies for the Alan Jones Award and the Hard Luck Trophy. For the Alan Jones



Award this is determined by the committee from the recommendations of members. Therefore, it's imperative that you provide secretary Julie with details of your nomination by 2nd February.

For those of you who have not already registered can I encourage you to book in for the 2023 National Rally in the Hunter. Even if you can only make it for a day or two. There will be a car display at the Hunter Gardens on Wednesday 3rd May and a run to the historic Tocal homestead in Paterson the following day - may the fourth be with you, for anyone who can find time in their busy schedules.

For a bit of useless information, let me relate what I have spent hours on achieving this last week. I have been getting messages telling me that I need to purchase additional storage on my Gmail account as it was 95.6% capacity. So I decided that I should do a bit of housekeeping (or do you call it decluttering) and found that I had over 34,000 pieces of correspondence, some of which went back nearly ten years. I deleted everything that was older than 12 months as I figured I wouldn't have known it was there and I'm now down to 15.6%. I'm a little

**Cont Page 5**

## COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Jim Phillips  
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Technical Officer - Greg Strange  
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Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn  
(Inc Conditional Registration)  
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

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[penmans@bigpond.com](mailto:penmans@bigpond.com)

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Public Officer - Alan Mitchell  
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Non-Committee Positions  
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts  
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion  
0414 472 877  
Geoff Smith  
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc  
PO Box 2754  
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.



# EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn  
(02) 4567 7380  
0417 673 065  
[p\\_quinn@tpg.com.au](mailto:p_quinn@tpg.com.au)

Greetings and welcome to the February 2023 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and I hope that so far the New Year has been treating you well.

I have noticed over the years that the preparation of the February Flat Chat has always been a bit of a chore. Without an event having occurred since the Christmas party in early December what's to fill in all the empty spaces? I went looking for things of interest and actually found quite a bit, but thanks to the good nature of some club members I have put these aside for another time.

So throughout the pages of this issue, you will find articles from founding and life member David Mould about his trip down memory lane with his 100 from home at Inverell to where he studied at Bathurst. Then from fellow founding member Robert Harrison we have an article on his red painted 100 engine and how it's fitted with side cooling. I have

left the photo really truly big, so you can see what it all means.

Thanks also to Geoff Golding for his missive titled 'Ah. Those were the Days.' Like many, I can remember catching trams across Sydney Harbour Bridge.

Matters on the Quinn Austin-Healey have not been moving quickly. After the Christmas/New Year festivities were but a memory, I along with our ever so useful Toyota Hilux picked up the engine block from Redi-strip at Blacktown where it had been holidaying and lounging about in the hot baths and spas. Coated with whatever anti-corrosion stuff they use, it did look the picture. Then it was just a matter to delivering it to the engine machinist at Castle Hill for him to do his bit.

After an exchange of some bits of



Painful would be the best way to describe how I feel having to do all this again.

paper, it will be picked up ready for assembly, which should take place over the next week or so. New dark green engine paint has been purchased and hopefully soon it will be running again, all thanks to Neville Stirton.

Talking about thanks. Many of them to club member Peter Flint for gleefully taking away hundreds of my old classic car magazines. I was really pleased that through various connections the boxes of the defunct Racing Car News will probably end with the National Motor Racing Museum at Bathurst.

Trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. I look forward to receiving plenty of contributions from members as after all there would be no point in publishing Flat Chat Newsletter each month without them.

## Monthly Meetings

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club  
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**

## MEMBERSHIP REPORT

Christine Lyttle

0410 201 373

[membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au](mailto:membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au)

No new members this month. Membership forms should be received from Chris Jenkins and Kim Gillis very soon.

Name badges for the last batch of members are ready to be distributed at the General Meeting on Thursday or at the Presentation Lunch on Sunday 5 February.

The Club has recently acquired credit card facilities which will incur a small surcharge of up to 2.2% of the cost of your membership, regalia item or rally ticket. Should you wish to use this service either at a club meeting, event, over the phone or entered on your membership form in the future we can certainly assist. Membership and Regalia officeholders currently hold these devices so make contact with Colin

Rule (Regalia) or myself (Membership, social events and Rally) to make a payment.

Don't forget to advise me if you change your address, email or any other details to ensure that we can keep your details as correct as possible. You can log in yourself and check the website changes.

Should you wish to attend the National Rally at the Hunter Valley from Tuesday 2 May – Friday 5 May 2023, it is not too late as there are still vacancies. Check the website for forms and details [www.austin-healeynsw.com.au/2023-national-rally/](http://www.austin-healeynsw.com.au/2023-national-rally/) or contact me by the rally email [rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com](mailto:rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com)

Keep safe and well!

Hope to see you at the Presentation Day Lunch!

Happy Healeying!  
Christine Lyttle

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## Central Coast Chapter Workshop

We are up and running folks with the first Central Coast Workshop for 2023 this Saturday, 4th February starting at 9 am. Where? 109 Humphreys Road, Kincumber South and yes it's on rain, hail or shine.

So don't forget your cookies and cake to share, coffee and tea will be on tap. All welcome!!!

The topic for the morning is detailing your Aus-

tin-Healey in readiness for our club Presentation Day Lunch on Sunday the 5th, held at Julie and Garry Lee's place, 20 Siletta Road Niagara Park starting time 11:30 am.

All the very best for now and Happy Healeying

Col and Kerrie Rule.





## Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493  
[Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com](mailto:Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com)  
 Denis Kasza 0407 492 008  
[deniskasza@gmail.com](mailto:deniskasza@gmail.com)

As mentioned last month a large and diverse list of events and activities have been planned that will make 2023 the best year ever. The more members that participate the better enjoyment of each who are there and the more diverse and interesting the discussions will be.

### Dates to Note:

4 February - Central Coast Technical Workshop  
 5 February - Presentation Day Lunch hosted by Julie & Garry Lee - See Below  
 7 February - Oasis Run Mooney Mooney  
 4 March - Central Coast Technical Workshop  
 11 March - Sydney Technical Workshop  
 18 March - Paradise Café Hawkesbury - Saturday Night Fish & Chips Run  
 1 April - Central Coast Technical Workshop  
 23 April - Thirlmere Railway Museum  
 2-5 May - National Rally  
 13 May - Sydney Technical Workshop  
 3 June - Central Coast Technical Workshop  
 10 June - Sydney Technical Workshop  
 24-25 June - Rose Café Goulburn  
 2 July - Donald Healey Birthday and Display Day  
 5 August - Central Coast Technical Workshop  
 12 August - Cherry Blossom Auburn Botanic Gardens  
 26 August - Continental Run - Centennial Park to La Pouse  
 2 Sep - Central Coast Technical Workshop  
 4-8 Sep - Painted Silo's Run - Western Districts  
 Sep - All British Day - Dates TBA

7 Oct - Central Coast Technical Workshop  
 14 Oct - Sydney Technical Workshop  
 Oct - Charlie's Run  
 4 Nov - Central Coast Technical Workshop  
 11 Nov - Sydney Technical Workshop  
 Dec - Christmas Party  
 Dec - Terribly British Day - Queanbeyan (Dates TBA)

Greater detail will be added to the events section of the AHOC NSW website, including times and location.

There are many more ideas and details to be added over coming weeks.

If you have ideas or a suggestion please contact us at the above.

Of course, the first big get together of the year is the Presentation Day Lunch to be held 5 February, 2023. This is a fully catered event subsidised by the AHOC. Generously hosted by Philip Bloom for many years, 2023 will see a change in venue to Julie and Garry Lee's new home at Niagara Park on the Central Coast.

### Event: Presentation Day Lunch

Date: Sunday 5 February 2023

Times: 11:00am - 3:00pm

Address: 20 Siletta Rd, Niagara Park

For members coming from the south we are meeting at the old Berowra Toll Gates at 9:30am (Departing 10:00am)

Cost: This event is subsidised by the AHOC. There is a small charge of \$10 per head.

Register: PLEASE register in advance so that we can cater accordingly or via the above.

### President's Message Cont.

embarrassed to have to report that there were quite a lot of unread emails in that lot, and for any of you who request a receipt when the email has been actioned and have now received acknowledgement for something that you have no idea about, then I extend my apologies. Now to clean

up the rest of them.

I'm looking forward to what 2023 has in store for our club.

Jim Phillips



FEB  
5



## AWARDS DAY LUNCH 11-3PM

**JULIE AND GARRY LEE'S  
20 SILETTA ROAD  
NIAGARA PARK**  
Southern members, meet  
Old Berowra Toll Gates  
9.30 dep 10am. Details  
Denis Kasza 0407492008



## Historic Vehicle Registration News

**If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.**

After the quite time surrounding Christmas and New Year, the renewals have certainly picked up with as many as five received in the one day. In addition members have taken to phone or email to let me know they are about to send their paperwork.

Please, unless you want a chat, there is no need to forewarn me that your paperwork is in, or is about to be in the post. I keep it all on an Excel spreadsheet and it's easy to see what's expected within a given period of time. However, there is always the possibility of Australia Post being less than efficient with the mail. So if you haven't received your signed paperwork back within, say a couple

of weeks, please get in touch so a new set can be sent to you.

Still the most frequent question is what needs to be done when it comes to renewal time. Just last week I had the following conversation:

*"I'm phoning on behalf of xxxx. Are you still the person who looks after registration?"*

*"Yes I am."*

*"Can you please tell me what I need to do to renew the registration of xxxx's car?"*

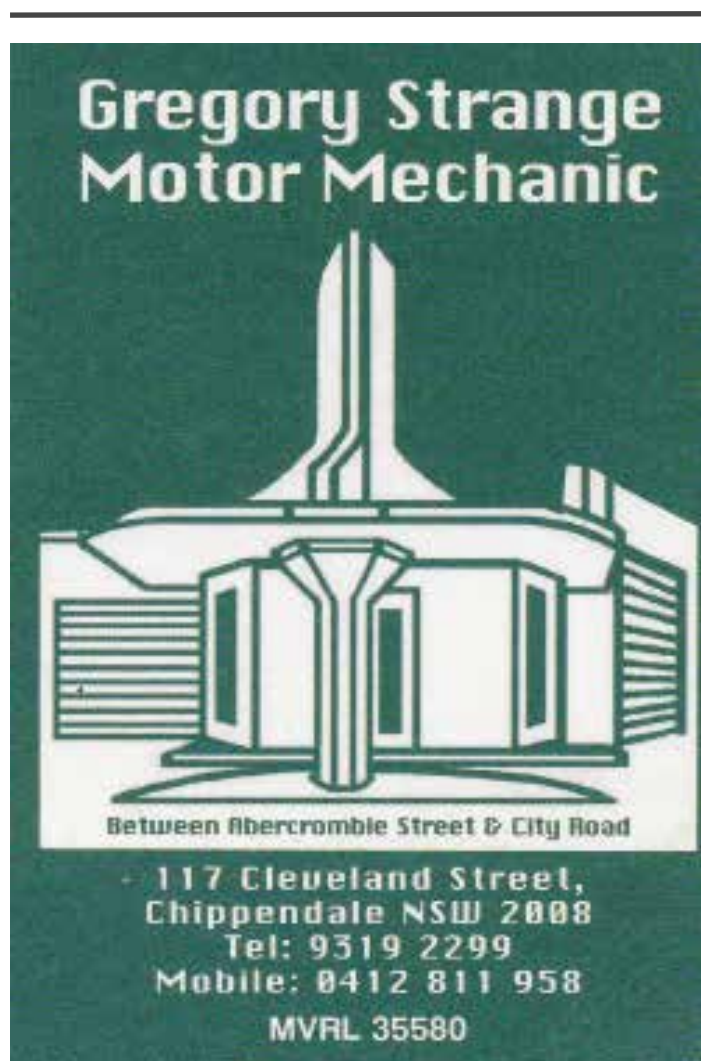
*"It's all explained in every issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. I have his email address and will send it to him."*

*"Thank you, but he never reads it."*

The latest *Flat Chat Newsletter* was sent, and the renewal paperwork was received a few days later. Below are the steps that need to occur.

- Once you have received the renewal from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this *Flat Chat* for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this *Flat Chat* for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.

**PLEASE DON'T FORGET THE STAMPED SELF-ADDRESSED ENVELOPE**



**Gregory Strange  
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,  
Chippendale NSW 2008  
Tel: 9319 2299  
Mobile: 0412 811 958  
MVRL 35580



## PAINTED SILOS TOUR - 4th to 8th September 2023 - Itinerary

### Monday - SEPTEMBER 4th

Depart Sydney  
Travel to HARDEN MURRUMBURRAH  
Silo location – Neill Street, Harden

Continue to GRENFELL

Silo location – 30 West Street, Grenfell

Continue to WEST WYALONG for overnight stay at either:-  
CAMEO MOTEL, 263 Neeld Street, \$120/night, 6 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2255

Or

COLONIAL MOTOR INN, 4 Ungarie Road, \$ 130/night, 10 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2611

TOTAL 530 KMS FOR DAY



Grenfell



Harden



Weethallie

### Tuesday - SEPTEMBER 5th

Depart West Wyalong to WEETHALLIE

Silo location – Railway Street, Weethallie

Continue travel on to DUBBO for overnight stay at

BLUE DIAMOND MOTOR INN, 113/115 Wingewarra Street, \$150/night, 10 Queen, 5 Twin rooms

Phone (02) 6882 0666

TOTAL 380 KMS FOR DAY



Dunedoo



Quirindi



Merriwa

### Wednesday - SEPTEMBER 6th

Depart Dubbo to DUNEDOO

Silo location – Castlereagh Highway, Dunedoo

Continue to MERRIWA

Silo location – Hackets Road, Merriwa

Continue to QUIRINDI via SCONE

Silo location – Quirindi

Overnight stay at BEST WESTERN MOTEL/RSL, \$148/night, two people

Phone (02) 6746 1995

TOTAL 340 KMS FOR DAY



Barraba



Gunnedah

### Thursday - SEPTEMBER 7th

Depart Quirindi to BARRABA,

Silo location – Manilla Road, Barraba

Continue travel to GUNNEDAH

Silo location – 2 Barber Street, Gunnedah

Overnight stay at the HARVEST LODGE MOTEL, 404 Conadilly Street, \$160 for night, 2 people

Phone: (02) 6742 3400

TOTAL 260 KM FOR DAY FOR DAY

### Friday - SEPTEMBER 8th

Depart Gunnedah to PORTLAND

Silo location – William Street, Portland

NO MOTEL ORGANISED, SOME MAY WISH TO TRAVEL HOME.

IF NOT, BOOK A MOTEL

TOTAL 350 KMS FOR DAY TO PORTLAND



Portland

If interested call either Denis Kasza on 0407 492 008, Terry Bancroft 0409 323 133 or email [bangers@bancroft.id.au](mailto:bangers@bancroft.id.au)







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## *Flat Chat Back Issues*

Interested in receiving backcopies of Flat Chat?  
Now available, digital copies of Flat Chat for 2005  
through to February 2023.

That's 200+ issues for you to read at your leisure.  
Free and gratis to members. All you have to do is send  
a 1-3GB USB (thumb) drive to me at the below address  
along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn  
"Wongaburra"  
116 Warks Hill Road  
Kurrajong Heights  
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&  
stamp) at a meeting.



## Memories Are Made of This

By David Mould

Back in January 1960, I bought my first Austin Healey – a BN1 engine numbered 1B220076M, and Larke Hoskins 100/133. It was registered BOO 508 (which was changed to SF 882 asap, as it was the thing to have black and white number plates on special cars) and had been repainted from its original colour of Healey Blue. It was now Briar Rose, (nice name for pink. PQ) and subject to much comment.



Briar Rose<sup>100</sup>

However let me go back a little earlier – from the time I left High School I had always hankered after an Austin-Healey. My work situation never allowed the money to get one though, as I had been an apprentice woolbuyer (read penciller for my boss) before taking a job in Barraba in Northern NSW in March 1958.

There I came across a schoolteacher by the name of Don Page, who was the lone teacher at Upper Bingara School - midway between Barraba and Bingara. Don used to pick me up on a Friday afternoon, and give me lift to Sydney, and the again collect me from my parents' house and we would drive through the night back to Barraba, and for Don on to Upper Bingara.

The odd thing was that Don was a product of Bathurst Teachers College (BTC), as was his girlfriend (later to become his wife), and she was posted to the Parramatta area upon graduating.

Barraba was a lonely little town in 1958, with a steam train terminus as a branch line from Tamworth. I did find out that a young chap living in Barraba had bought a brand new Austin-Healey, but I believe he had sold it (not good roads in those days) and had moved away from Barraba. Tamworth also had a few Austin-Healeys at that time.

I managed to “sweat out” Barraba and a very lonely existence until November 1958, when Don convinced me to consider entering the teaching profession. So I had a medical exam with the local doctor in Barraba, resigned my position, and headed back to Sydney to await posting to a teacher training establishment.

And oddly enough, I was given a scholarship and a posting as a “live-in” student at BTC. In the years 1959 and 1960 our “intake” was of approximately 220 students, made up of the majority as boarders, but a few were billeted “downtown” - both males and females. There were approximately 70 males and 150 females in our intake, and the previous intake of 1958/59 would be leaving at the end of 1959.

By this time in my life, I had been fairly active with my best mate in events conducted by the North Shore Sporting Car Club – mainly car trials, economy runs, with the occasional hillclimb - mainly at Mona Vale, but also at Silverdale, and sometimes Bathurst. He owned the car, I navigated.

And so, being incarcerated at BTC (now Charles Sturt University) was convenient, as the college grounds actually bordered Pit Straight, but really cramped my motorsport activities – other than when the car racing was on at Mt Panorama, and my mate and I got together as flag marshals, or for me sometimes in the control tower.

I was unable to travel back home to Sydney until May 1959, and it was then I found a Fiat 500D for sale at Terrey Hills. A bit of careful explanation as to the added convenience of having my own wheels persuaded my parents to finance me, and I bought the Fiat. It did wonderful service between Bathurst and Sydney, albeit rather painful through the mountainous, but beautiful drives through Kurrajong and Bells Line of Road.

The advertisement for a BN1 in the Sydney Morning Herald in January 1960 was a real drawcard, and a discussion with parents as the benefits of a big lazy motor, brought a required result, and I traded the Fiat in at Harden and Johnston at Camperdown, for a 1955 BN1.



**Memories cont'**

Now the trips up and back, to and from Bathurst, became an absolute delight. I can remember heading through Yetholme one Friday afternoon, hood down, with snowflakes drifting up and over the screen. Magic Stuff!!



I found two BN1s in Bathurst in 1960 – one owned by a local taxi owner, with 21000 miles on the clock, and the other owned by a local electrician. The former was purchased in 1972, I think, by Geoff Fry, and the latter I think ended up in Frank Matich's service station in East Roseville.



I can remember making friends with the son of the local soft drink manufacturer, and one dismal day he and I took his Porsche 356 Carrera to lay down a car trial for the Bathurst Light Car Club.

Fast forward to 2019, and it has been 60 years since BTC. Reunions are planned, and cancelled, postponed at least two or three times, but finally in 2022 a reunion becomes a reality. And what better way to enjoy a visit to the Alma Mater, than to take my current BN1 which I have owned for 56 years (Engine No. 1B224020 and Larke Hoskins 100/260) and show it what its older brother saw and did 60 years ago.

I left Inverell at 0730 hours on Sunday 6th November 2022. Planned route through Singleton, the Howes Valley and thence Kurrajong and Bells Line of Road became a "no-go" due to road washaways, unfortunately. I was hoping to try and remember how the old BN1 used to tackle the long climbs between Kurrajong and Lithgow, as these roads were used in the early days of "Wheels" and "Modern Motor" as test routes. In those days light traffic permitted road testing on such interesting thoroughfares.

It was not to be. So I had to plan a stop somewhere in Sydney suburbia, and stay overnight, continuing on Monday morning. I chose a motel at Mt Kuring Gai, and can only recommend that establishment highly. Run now by Chinese (Shirley and I had stayed there back in 2000 with different proprietors) the service and the food were absolutely superb - highly recommended.



On Monday morning I joined the rabble and not having been in the area for more than 20 years, promptly lost my way around the back of Hornsby, while trying to make my way through St Ives to the East Gordon area and try to make contact with the

**Memories cont'**

current owners of our house – which my parents bought brand new from the builder in 1953, and sold in 1969.

Unfortunately, no one was home and the place looked rather unkempt and much overgrown. (included are pictures from 1962, and now 2022 – different cars, same place).



Once again hitting the traffic, I promptly used the wrong lane(s) and had to spend time trying to find what I could remember from back in the '60s. Eventually I found my way to Carlingford and cheap fuel, before heading to Penrith and over the Blue Mountains, arriving in Bathurst just after midday.

The various activities planned by our organising group saw coffee and the later a full dinner at Panthers Club on the first day. A bus tour, beginning with a very, very slow circuit around the track, took us around the sights of Bathurst, Eglinton and back to the university to be welcomed by the university staff. I really did not expect the function for lunch to be so comprehensive, and we were welcomed like very old friends. (That's right, very old.....!!)

A full-blown dinner for all was held at Rydges Mount Panorama dining room, and entertainment was provided.

That basically concluded the four-day trip, and I left Bathurst at 6.30am on Wednesday, driving straight through to Inverell in the day, with stops for fuel at Carlingford and Tamworth, and a lunch break at Muswellbrook. I arrived home at 5.30pm – some 545 miles in one hit, and approximately 27 mpg.

The BN1 performed faultlessly, and I was proud to show that a car which was quite a hit in 1960 could be just as good 60 years later.



Merry Christmas from Anchorage Alaska where the average winter temperature is  $-12$  to  $-5^{\circ}\text{C}$  with an average winter snowfall of 192 cm.





Unforgettable memories...



# RALLY NEWS

January 2023

Three months to go!

**HEALEYS IN THE HUNTER** is getting close!

At last count there were only 9 rooms left. If you haven't done so yet, book your room at Chateau Elan without delay.

After 31 January the Chateau will accept bookings from non-Rallyers. Get in quick or risk not being there at all.

Since the last Rally News, we've been busy refining our program. The latest addition is for [Thursday morning](#), when we will visit [Tocal Homestead](#).

As the most interesting wineries tend to be the smallest ones, we couldn't book specific winery visits for our numbers. Instead, we have identified some wineries that you might like to visit on your way back to [Chateau Elan](#) from the organised drives or from [Tocal Homestead](#). Check your welcome pack for details.

Our [program of events](#) now looks like this:



## Tuesday 2 May

Check in to [Chateau Elan](#) from 3pm and pick up your welcome pack at [Rally Registration](#). Then at 7pm join everyone on the [Fairway Lawn](#) for Canapes (finger food) and drinks.

## Wednesday 3 May

Up early for a final polish, then drive your car to the [Austin-Healey display](#) to view the other cars ([10am to 12 noon](#)). Enjoy [Hunter Valley Gardens](#) or browse the shops at [Pokolbin Village](#), taste some wine or vodka, or pick up a memento or two, or just stop for coffee and cake.

Wednesday afternoon is your opportunity for a visit to the [Spa](#) or play a round of [Golf](#) at the Vines (advance bookings essential, contact [Chateau Elan](#)) or just enjoy the [Hunter Valley](#). There is so much to visit, see and enjoy in the Hunter, from the [Army Infantry Museum](#) at Singleton to the [artisan cheesemakers](#), [brewers](#), or follow a [convict trail](#). It is all there for your enjoyment.

This evening is [Party Night – Do the Healey Hop!](#) Your two course dinner begins at 7pm in the [Founders Room](#), followed by as much dancing as anyone could want, or just enjoy chatting to friends old and new. Our band is [Bad Sneakers](#) who play great 60s and 70s danceable music to entice the [Healey Hop!](#) Be comfortable and bring your [best or worst sneakers, decorated or plain, they might win a prize!](#)

## Thursday 4 May

This morning enjoy an organised country drive to [Tocal Homestead in Paterson](#) for a tour and light lunch. This is a picturesque and historic house and farm dating from the 1820s and 1830s. After lunch, continue to historic [Hunter port town of Morpeth](#), and perhaps take a stroll through [Kurri Kurri](#) to view the more than [60 fabulous murals](#) scattered throughout the village on the way back to [Chateau Elan](#). Or you can join our guided drive to picturesque [Wollombi village](#).

For something different: [Maitland Art Gallery](#) is well worth a visit and has a great coffee shop; be wowed by the gorgeous views from the [Audrey Wilkinson winery's](#) hilltop location; or from the [Mt Bright lookout](#); or maybe book a [Go-Kart](#) session at nearby Kearsley and then test your putting prowess on the adjacent [Mount Panorama mini-golf](#). These and more are available for your enjoyment!

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Thursday is your opportunity for a round of [Golf](#) at the Vines or to be pampered at the [Spa](#) (early bookings essential for both).

This evening is the [Gala Dinner](#). We will congregate in the [Founders Room](#) for dinner to wrap up this Rally and to learn about the 2024s Rally which will be held in WA.

### Friday 5 May

Sadly, this morning it is time to pack our bags and say goodbye until next year. Join everyone for a [Farewell Brunch](#) in the restaurant (\$39.50 per person if you haven't included breakfasts with your accommodation booking).

Why not book in a day early, it's not too late, take advantage of the special accommodation rate offered to our Austin-Healey members to enjoy the exclusive [Chateau Elan](#) and book a [Spa](#) treatment or a round of [Golf](#)!

Should you have any questions about the rally please do not hesitate to contact the committee via the designated email [rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com](mailto:rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com) and one of the rally committee will reply depending on your query.

That's it for now, look out for more news next month!

### Your Rally Committee



Photo by Tracy Appel, [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:147\\_-\\_Tocal\\_Homestead\\_\(5045676b2\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:147_-_Tocal_Homestead_(5045676b2).jpg)

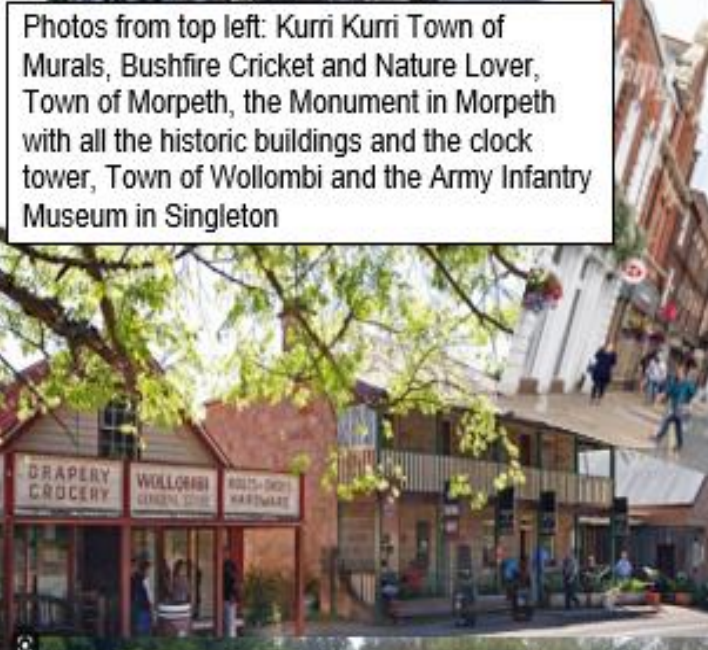
Tocal Homestead <https://www.tocalhomestead.com.au/>

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Photos from top left: Kurri Kurri Town of Murals, Bushfire Cricket and Nature Lover, Town of Morpeth, the Monument in Morpeth with all the historic buildings and the clock tower, Town of Wollombi and the Army Infantry Museum in Singleton







## THE RED ENGINES

By Rob Harrison

I sold my 100 BN1 in 1966 and its engine number was IB/219105M. For years I really missed the 100 as it was an easier car to enjoy than the 3000 and it had sentimental value being the car in which I got my driver's licence.

The years went by and in the '80s I was in a position to buy another 100 and it so happened that my old car, in a dilapidated condition, was for sale and I was able to buy it from a well-known Austin-Healey restorer, Terry Cornelius (who many would know is a genius who built the Kieft DeSoto engined racing car, constructing the chassis and body from photos. On completion it ran at the Goodwood Revival, much to Terry's delight).

Terry agreed to restore the 100 to a usable condition and not in any way a concours car.

Unfortunately, the original engine had been fitted to another 100 (now in Perth. PQ), and the replacement engine fitted was highly modified. I suggested to Terry to sell the engine and I would look for a standard 100 unit, but fortunately, he talked me into keeping the modified engine as it was fitted to the car in the early '70s as it had been raced extensively during that period. It still holds the fastest time for a mod sports car at the now defunct Amaroo Park Hillclimb.

The engine was built by an aeronautical engineer working from one of our airports. It was fitted a set of Derrington extractors fitted, a single Weber 45 DCOE (which I later exchanged for two SUs) external water rails and a 3 15/16 inch bore plus roller rockers. The body was lightened by fitting alloy floor panels with alloy bonnet and boot lid, but all the other panels were original. The special engine when installed in its original chassis, 60 odd years ago was doing 14 secs at Castlereagh Drag Strip just outside Sydney. However, the car was written off and the special engine was rescued by well known Austin-Healey specialist, Barry Birch and put in my old car. It was known as the "red engine" as the block

was painted red, and any time that the head was off it was surrounded by Austin-Healey enthusiasts amazed at the large bore and Chevrolet truck pistons. Everyone thought the engine was an industrial stationary unit and not a Austin-Healey engine. Fortunately, AHOC member Chris Dimmock found the logbook and generously gave it to me. The engine numbers in the logbook did not match my engine which over the years had the deck shaved making the engine number hard to read.

Next, I tracked down that these engines ended up in 100s sold by Barry Birch some time ago. However, with the help of the British Motor Industry Heritage Trust at Gaydon, they ascertained that my engine number is IB/219604M and was in fact originally fitted to a 100 imported to Sydney in 1954, which was the car that was so successful at Castlereagh Drag Strip.

Prior to reinstalling the engine back into my car, I decided to paint the head in red assuming it was a BMC colour. However, after purchasing a tin of BMC engine red, it was found to be a different shade. Maybe this paint was the maroon colour which the A90 engines were painted? However, after a lot of research I discovered that the colour was actually Nuffield Tractor Poppy Red.

Since then, a road test of the David Shale 100, restored beautifully by Rawles in the UK, revealed that this it had a red engine, later painted in the 100 green engine colour. Another Austin-Healey 100 came up for sale in the US and this car was totally original and the owner claimed that the engine was always red.

Nuffield tractors were known as the Rolls-Royce of tractors, but they had dated side-valve Morris engines and with the advent of BMC, there was a rationalisation of the engines available and the Nuffield tractors were tested with OHV Austin power plants, most of which ended up being fitted to BMC tractors which replaced the Nuffield brand. The popular en-

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**The February meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 2nd at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Come along from 5.30pm and enjoy dinner in the bistro with your fellow club members.**

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**Red Engines cont'**

gines used were the B series and the big Austin truck engines, however there was also the diesel version of the A70 which went into production. My theory is that a certain number of A90 petrol engines were tested but never used in production. These engines were selected from a batch of A90 blocks which had thicker walls in the castings and painted red.

I remember in the mid-70s a friend of mine worked with me at Leyland Australia and he was in experimental and was given the job of selecting alloy P76 V8 blocks which were cast with thicker walls. These blocks went to Repco and machined for use in the Repco Leyland F5000 engines fitted to John Mc Cormack's McLaren M23 which won the F5000 Championship. They were known as the IMC engines (Irving-McCormack). Phil Irving was a bril-

liant Australian engineer who designed the Vincent V2 motorcycle engine and later the Repco-Brabham V8 which won the World F1 championship for Sir Jack Brabham in 1966 and 1967 with a redesigned block.

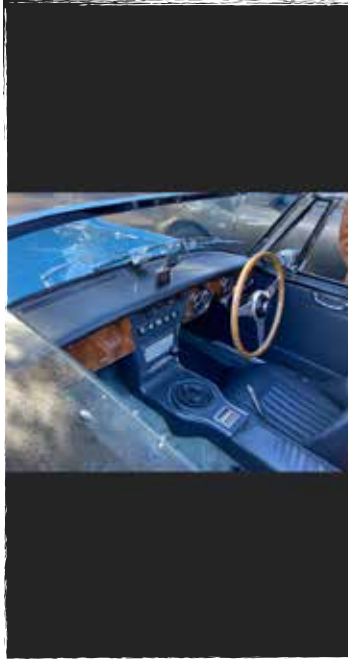
The proposed use of the A90 engine in the BMC tractors is speculation on my part, but why would so few 100 engines be painted in Nuffield Poppy Red?

It will be interesting to see how the modified engine performs on the open road and hope it brings back those wonderful memories I have of the car when I owned it 57 years ago. Unfortunately, it will not have the nostalgic smells I remember of worn persimmon red leather, but no doubt will retain the wonderful sound and oscillation of the motor as it springs into life on the press of the button.





MAR  
**18**



## **SAT NIGHT FISH & CHIPS**

**6.30 to 8.30 pm  
PARADISE CAFE, LOWER  
PORTLAND  
Meet at McGraths Hill  
Maccas 5pm dep 6pm.  
Contact Denis Kasza for  
details on 0407492008**



## AH! Those were the days!

By Geoff Golding

Isn't it funny? These days when people talk about times gone by, they always say something like "Back in the 1980s" (inferring it's a long time ago). Yes that's a while ago to most folks BUT, what about when you say back in the 1940s or '60s? Invariably you get a quizzical look with an expression of "Are you that old?" OR similar (I must be showing my age here.) It's interesting, as it reflects how slowly, but surely we are all aging and changing. Old age waits for nobody.

As a teenager, I used to be taken to Lapstone Hill on the Great Western Highway by my parents, for the Veteran Car Club's annual run to Katoomba. Watching the then "old cars" struggle with the climb, a cloud of blue smoke usually followed. On reflection it was quite an inspiring sight as the "single lung" cars slowly proceeded towards Katoomba. As you will realise the cars then were often 50 or more years old, all beautifully restored and "Gee they were old," in the eyes of your then teenager scribe, who did not realise, in his then youth, he would own such a vehicle. How times have changed! They "Were the good old days!"

So what else has changed – let's take a paragraph or two to look generally at motoring and society? Back in the '60s we had trams now called "light rail" (have one run over your foot and you'd quickly realise this title for these vehicles is incorrect!) in George and Elizabeth Street and out through various suburbs both north and south of the harbour. The conductors ("Clippies" as they were nick-named) scampering along the running boards, come rain hail or shine, checking and selling tickets. OH&S? What's that? Those were the days!

Then there was the development in the city with the original AMP Building being built at Circular Quay and the Opera House destined to being built too on Bennelong Point financed by the Opera House lottery tickets (how many of those did we all buy looking for "Easy Street" in your life?) It seemed Sydney's CBD was coming of age.

For ladies to go into the city it was fashionable to dress up with hat, gloves and of course high heeled shoes. Gents all wore suits (with a tie). Today "Grun-

ge" seems to be the fashion and in my mind's eye, there was a certain elegance in seeing the female species dress up "fit to kill". Wasn't society different in this and many other respects? Those were the days.

Things motoring wise were very interesting, Rex Round Australia rallies were such that crowds would line the streets of towns on the route to watch the cars scurry past in a cloud of dust and pebbles. Newspapers would record the place getters and points lost on a daily basis (done without email or text messaging). Would Ken Tubman remain as leader across the Nullarbor, or would Jack Murray snatch the lead, aided by a stick of gelignite? Those were the days.

William Street was the mecca of all the car dealers with Wentworth Avenue being the alternate area where cars were bought and sold. Marques like MG, Austin, Jaguar, Riley, MG and to a lesser extent the American makes e.g. Buick, Oldsmobile, Chev, and some European makes like Fiat, VW, Alfa Romeo, Peugeot were all represented and others from Japan, Toyota, Nissan et-al ... were breaking into the Australian market. Of course, Holden and Ford were generally speaking the "Aussie vehicle of choice" The FX and FJ with their column shifts." Those were the days.

Names like Lancaster Motors, John Crouch, Ron Ward, and Bill Buckle, along with a number of others who were familiar as racing drivers e.g. the Geoghegan brothers, Frank Matich, Jack Brabham, Norn Beechey with his very potent FJ Holden, David McKay with the LM 250 Ferrari – that was a sight to see and hear at Warwick Farm. Jack Myers (who was the NSW agent for Lukey Mufflers) and a successful driver on various circuits e.g. Goon Blas, and Bathurst in NSW in his MG TC Special.

Those days were straightforward, with a man's word being his honour. The 'give way to the right' road rule on our roads, almost guaranteeing an accident with merging traffic involved. There were no speed radar or breath testing or drugs and traffic lights were few and far between. Ah bliss! To drive along Parramatta Road looking at secondhand car yards and



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**Days cont'**

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seeing what was on offer. Yes those were the days!

There were Austin-Healeys, but not that many. John Thompson with his passion and sports cars generally was always worth stopping at and having a good look through the fence and drooling at the MGs and other makes of sports cars in stock.

As the car dealers changed their loyalties from British manufactures to Japanese so the supply of spare parts for British and European car parts became scarce forcing some makes of cars off the road.

This developed an “entrepreneurial mindset” in the car enthusiast, which in turn, aided the development of the car clubs with more enthusiasts seeing the benefit of joining one of the many available. We all witnessed the car clubs really coming of age around the early ‘70s and growing quickly for two or three decades. The AHOC being a typical example.

The traditional wrecking yard with oil soaked dirt floors are virtually all gone from NSW. When a particular model come in, club members soon found out about it, and would swoop like crows, scavenged a carcass on the side of the road to obtain that elusive needed part, on the basis none of the members of the club would have one on the shelf and the dealers had disposed of their old spare parts.

It was also amazing how a part from a FJ Holden would fit a Jaguar and it didn’t matter if it was a valve for the head or a rubber grommet for the bodywork. Additionally, some clubs started spare parts businesses where they would have parts made to original specs.

These parts were for club members only, and thus the spare parts fund ensured growth of the club that applied the “possessed leverage” for new members. The Riley Motor Club of Australia was one such club, with a very successful business these days, supplying parts to members across Australia and NZ.

The activities by car club members led to the development of a vast knowledge base on how to make some difficult repair, or deal with a business was receptive to assisting with the enthusiast’s quest for the repair. This unofficial grape vine was worth its weight in gold.

These days we are spoilt, you just get online and aided by a parts listing, you can order literally any part for your Austin-Healey either here in Australia or the UK from a variety of sources, And the parcel arrives in a week or so. It’s all so easy!

It was in those days, Austin-Healeys were a “sports car of choice” for all forms of motorsport, some cars had a very hard life immediately after leaving the dealer’s showroom. Of course “Tin Worm” played havoc with bodywork aided by alloy panels ‘butting’ straight on to steel with the inevitable electrolysis causing havoc, all aided by wet carpets and the wet carpet “aroma” which was, and still is quite distinctive. Ah. Those were the days.

Around the mid ‘70s professional classic car restoration businesses started to develop. This development was made possible by companies like “The Healey Factory” and “Kilmartin Sheet Metal” in Australia (along with many other small one band businesses – a new industry was born which has grown considerably across Australia. The parts suppliers in the UK starting to provide a great service making a restoration “easy”.

Back in the 1960s, the home car restorer/mechanic had a lot of enthusiasm, a few spanners and pieces of equipment, eg. some screwdrivers, maybe a vice and an electric drill, all located possibly in a double car garage; more often than not it was a single garage with work being carried out on the drive or front lawn.

There were no spray booths, so to repaint a car and do a good job, was a long and arduous process with many undercoats, lots of sanding back, then a couple of coats of top coat which had to be cut back to get the shine, polishing with a buff using cutting compound and finally car polish which was difficult to polish off and was usually a half day job to finish without streaks.

Today it’s a different story, spray booths, sanding usually completed by a machine, filler undercoats and two pack paint, one colour and one clear, no polishing, just strip the masking tape off – Done job!

The simple task of polishing a car these days is almost non-existent, due to modern paints and finishes.

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**Days cont'**

The availability of tools was relatively limited to the home restorer due to the cost. Spanner manufacturers in Australia were SIDCHROME, good quality but expensive. Rotisseries for body restorations were unheard of, but the small Chinese made hydraulic jack were relatively inexpensive were starting to appear in the restorer's garage along with a great variety of items of equipment all designed to make the restoration easier i.e. the small engine hoist on wheels as opposed to the rope and pulley from the rafters or floor joist of the home where the garage was underneath.

Austin-Healeys, particularly the BN1 and BN2 were regularly seen in the traffic and affection for the marque grew quickly. Today, park your Austin-Healey in a street and it's not long before someone is looking long and hard at it with a facial expression of pleasure and thoughts like "If only I had not sold mine in 1969 or in the '70s", These thoughts usually led to a protracted conversation, which in itself is very pleasant as a current Austin-Healey owner.

Following on from the advent of the six-cylinder models in the mid-'50s the sporting image also grew with enthusiasts like Ross Bond and his car becoming very competitive, winning on most NSW circuits for several years in an era when Motorsport "became of age". The days when straw bales along with truck and car tyres were the safety guards of choice have given way to Armco railing, "hi-vis" jackets and track officials standing in the pouring rain or scorching sun. Technology has seen the need for a "regiment" of track officials disappear to run a motor race/sport event. A shame as being an official at a race meeting is a very good way to get up close and personal to the action.



Sydney in the '60s and a Sydney tram – The coat hanger has not changed much over the last 70 years.

Back in the '60s and '70s, there was little or no advertising on cars on the track in fact Jack Brabham got into trouble for advertising on his Cooper Bristol, you could see the car number and the person driving. The cars did not have any "ground effect" technology. Visually they raced just as "they came off the showroom floor" but with tweaked engines and maybe sway bars and stiffer shock absorbers. Ah. Those were the days.

Motorsport in the '60s and '70s was an interesting time, there were hillclimbs at Amaroo Park, initially when it first opened the surface was dirt sprayed with sump oil to try and compress the surface, it was moderately successful.



Not a lot has change in the traffic density ion 60 years – note the line of busses on the right of the photo.

Then Foleys Hill off Mona Vale Road, a "shortish track" that I think the Northshore Sporting Car Club would hire from the Warringal Council for the day. It was a public road that was closed off for a day. The start was literally a few yards from Mona Vale Road and it weaved up the hill and was very popular with those of us who lived anywhere north of Spit Bridge.

Silverdale Hillclimb attracted a substantial field of usually well-known names. Castlereagh, a disused WWII runway, with a gravel surface which would peel rubber from your tyres was fun in that a car club could hire and have an interesting day's motorsport usually without interference from the "fun Police. Oh, weren't times simple but fun. There was also a track at Schofields (ex RAAF base. PQ) which I never went to, but it was a good event location.

All these circuits/facilities have been the victim of no more hay bales and worn-out tyres for safety and in came Armco railing and "Officials" (some may



### Days cont'

say "the fun Police" have spoilt the fun of Motorsport at local club level due to rules and regulations. Of course, the cost of competing has to be taken into account, which is significant today.

Once upon a time if you knew a farmer with a paddock, a club like ours could pay the farmer a "small stipend" and have a club gymkhana AND a lot of fun, safely. (We did! PQ) In reality it was all low speed and just matching your wits against the clock.

These days the paperwork to organise a similar event would "choke a Camel" and then of course there are all those "greedy authorities" with hands out wanting unreasonably high amounts of cash to issue a piece of paper authorising the event.

So far as racetracks were concerned there were several until the development of suburbia forced their closure. Clearly Warwick Farm was the pre-eminent venue and places like Mt Druitt, Amaroo Park, Oran Park were very popular, but then Wakefield in Goulburn was developed, but all those are now gone.

Then there were the trials run by many car clubs on public roads into the "quiet roads" of the Hawkesbury plains, through to Wisemans Ferry and the like. Those of us who competed were really living a dream of doing a couple of stages in the Ampol or Redex trial usually the Police "were otherwise occupied" as we all had fun and then around midnight telling tall tales but true of our exploits in a pub or someone's home somewhere and drive home. Ah. Those were the days!

These days we have all adapted to the changes over the last 60, 70 or even 80 years; some of the changes have been forced upon us e.g. the rising cost of tolls, no club gymkhanas on a farmer's paddock and those "pesky" radar traps where unmarked cars have cameras "taking our pictures" as we drive past.

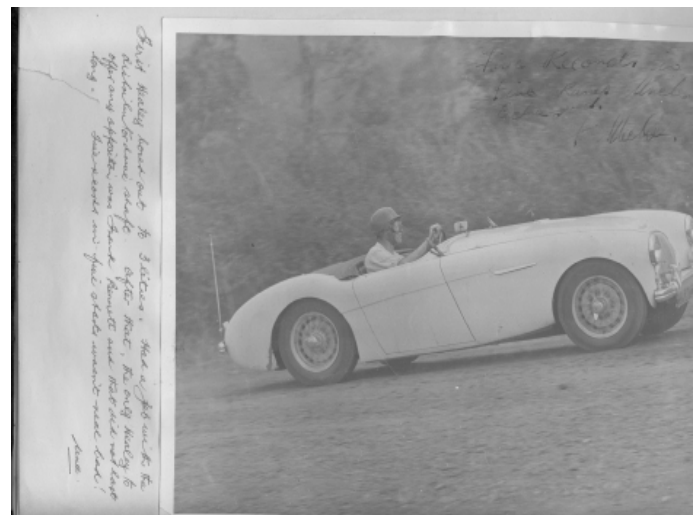
On the other hand, things like the Internet are extremely useful and available and we all access the information therein, be it medical advice, to how to fix something, to do our banking without going near to a bank branch. For those who are challenged by this technology I feel very sorry for their plight; particularly those older folks who don't have a lot of social discourse and to go to a bank branch with a

savings passbook and withdraw some cash and have a chat with a REAL person i.e. the teller, this is now lost forever, be it city or country environ

These days it's generally not possible to have a difference of opinion over something without being bullied, called a racist or just brushed aside as being a "silly out-of-touch old person". The folks who pursue this attitude simply forget the older folks in the community are the people who set the foundations for our society today AND fought in wars to give us all the freedoms and good things Australia has to offer.

So do I think it's as good as it's going to get here in Australia. NAH! I think we have had the best over the last 65 or 70 years, given technology and the advancements in all aspects of our lives. I can remember as a nine or ten year-old flying from Broken Hill in a DC3 aircraft to Melbourne. It was summer and we bounced all the way due to the air pockets (or as they say these days "Turbulence"). Modern aircraft take it all in their stride, but the DC3 was heaving and tossing like a bull at a rodeo. Modern air travel is a wonderful experience particularly international.

Looking at car prices in the 1960s and '70s they have change enormously along with clearly the cost of living. Taking our favoured make, these days in what is acknowledged as being a "slow down" in the economy, a reasonably road going and registered Austin-Healey is valued somewhere in the range of \$50,000 to \$120,000+ (depending on condition and if restored the quality of the restoration), a far cry from the Austin-Healeys advertised in Flat Chat in the '70s.



**Days cont'**

The two photos proceeding typify motorsport in the '50s and '60s. Frank Matich in his Austin-Healey 100 on Silverdale Hillclimb. In the trees 'Pudding Basin Stack Hat', no roll bar to protect the driver, no Armco railing or for that matter no vehicle tyres (just the bush). Simple days where we enjoyed our motorsport as a competitor or spectator.

I draw your attention to the handwritten notation of the top photo which is self-explanatory which Frank Matich signed. Clearly the car was driven to the track, competed and drove it home. (In a number of interviews I had with Frank, he said that the 100 was his only car that was used for everything. PQ)

Ah! Those were the days!



Austin-Healeys at Warwick Farm, with Armco making an appearance in the top ph



A 3000 Mk1, with hardtop slowly succumbing to gravity somewhere in the US.

Should I or you tell them that the front guard flashes are on back to front?



## For Sale 1955 Austin-Healey 100

This car is visually as it came off the showroom floor with gleaming Carmen Red exterior, silver powder coated wheels and full black leather trim with black carpet.

Delivered new in Sydney, this 100 (BN1/224691) led a chequered life as far as we can ascertain with eight previous owners. These days it's thought, if not all but some parts now comprising the car are from the Austin Healey owned by the motor racing legend the late Frank Match.

Research has led us to believe this car is a combination of three vehicles during its life and prior to our purchasing the car in late 2006, it was raced in club events including the Calder six-hour relay races in the 1970s by then owner Chris Gray. Photos of the car at Warwick Farm in the 1960s are also available indicating this it was very much of the 1960s and early '70s motor racing scene.



## For Sale

With the car go photos of the body off restoration carried out in 2002-3 by the then owner. There are photos of a full engine rebuild in 2011; along with a log of all repairs and parts purchased during our ownership. At one stage during the 1980s, the car was written off and rebuilt using a new-old-stock 100 Chassis.

This Austin-Healey has won best 100 Road Car in the AHOC 2012 Concours.

Mechanically, while far from standard provides great performance without taking away reliability. Visually the car is in very good condition with no rust in the body work.

Further details from Geoff Golding on 0459 767 340.





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## Memories of a trip to Calder in 1974

Following on from my missive last month covering my first five years with the AHOC I received four pages from Ian (Skins) Thomson (now a AHC of WA member) that were originally published in the November 1974 issue of Flat Chat. It was written by

Dennis Wraight who was then an active member . It was and during the time when members were encourage to type their own articles on to a Gestetner stencil.

Patrick Quinn and 23 at the time.

### TRIPPING SOUTH, THEN BACK NORTH, AND WHAT HAPPENED IN BETWEEN.

I set out on this epic adventure in the passenger seat of Pat's 100/4. We set off at 2 o'clock in the morning so we could get to Melbourne about 1.30. The weather was beautiful about 60 m.p.h. winds below 100. So wrapped up in balaclavas, scarves gloves and jackets we then ventured forth. We set off down the Olympic Highway going great guns the car was really going grouse. Not far out of Cowra I told Pat that the car was really going grouse and that is great praise for 100/4 however just entering Cowra it happened the shock absorber ripped the top off the mount and rather badly mangling it in the process. So I straightened it up while pat found out if we could get it fixed anywhere, we were lucky but we had to wait till 8.30 which was 2 1/2 hours away. Just as we got the wheel back on, Golly Wates, Roger Miller and Skins Thomson pulled up and proceeded to kill every tree in general vicinity. Finally the garage opened and we got under way except the fixer upper turned out to be me after some pretty rough repairs we again set off but not before I asked Pat to get me some fencing wire to bind the shocky up if it broke again. Pat then proceeded to pull down a newly erected railway fence to get some wire.

Off we went with Skins going ahead as rough rider to pick the bumps then us then Wally & Roger. Who were swearing rather profusely about the rough roads. We pulled up for a check of the car at Wagga Wagga and it just happened to be outside a pub so while I was checking the shocky the scouts were sent out to perouse the beer situation.

So after a can of beer and a sausage roll and many looks from the locals I don't know if it was the cars our scruffy appearance as we sat in the gutter sucking tubes or our good looks. Anyway it didn't worry us too much so we set off again. With all systems go and skins in the lead. At about Hay a speedster in a Holden Ute who got sick of 3 Healeys dodging and stopping for bumps decided to pass us, he got past Wally and us then a Mazda in front of us then Bang! before he could pass skins our bump dodger rough rider put a rock through his windscreen. and he came to a shattering standstill. Our next stop was a little town whose name now eludes me where we stopped to fix Wally's exhaust which had shaken loose of its mounting bracket. Wally saw a Toyota Dealer across a couple roads and bought some nuts and bolts, at which they asked Wally for a part number. Tall about Dumb. Gee!

While all this was going on a local groover was going up and down the road in his M.G.B. putting on a show for us on about his 6th lap a member of the local constabulary pulled him up and gave him a defect sticker. (all M.G.'s should be given one) So after a bit of a chuckle we set off again. We stopped for lunch at Wodonga where I thought I got the deal of a life time. I had 3 steak sandwiches, 1 egg and bacon roll and 2 milkshakes and gave the woman a \$5 note and she gave me \$4.24 change. She only charged me for one steak sandwich I promptly scooped and pulled up at the nearest piece of gutter and started to

continued...





TRIPPING SOUTH, THEN BACK NORTH, AND WHAT HAPPENED IN BETWEEN continued,

scoff into it. However the steak sandwich was a disaster the steak was yuk and the bread was 1 inch thick and green with penicillin. So I didn't get to good a deal after all. And It was starting to feel very happy to leave Wodonga, I was never really fond of it anyway. So off we headed the time now about 5.30 and it was starting to get dark along the way. Skins was staring to get tired so Roger got in with him. Wally turned up his radio full blast & Pat and I sang Waltzing Matilda very loudly and pretty roughly and was like this that we finally reached Malbourne where we seperated and went our seperate ways. Pat and I were staying at Steven and Helen Pikes place and we arrived there about 9.30. Not to bad a trip only took us about 22 hours. Even if a 3000 could make it in 12 hours. We finally got to bed about 1.30 on Saturday morning and boy oh boy did we ever sleep.

Steve got us up at about 6.30 then we went out for practice day where all went pretty well. When it was nearly over we went home to work on Pat's car again. This time to make it a more permanent job. We went out for tea then into a get together at Terry Wades's. residence. We got home at about 12.00 and bed about 1.00.

I got up at six and did some more work on Pat's car nearly completing it only had to put it together. We then left for the track.

We must have put up a good show because I saw some of the race this time. It was great day. The only dramas were "Tubby" Ben cracked a piston. (trying to be a Alan Moffat and beat Tor-anas) and Barry Birch a pressure plate ventilating his bell housing somewhat. Anyway we were going to put Barry's head on Ben's because we thought Ben had a blown head gasket but when we found the cracked piston we change the pressure plate from Ben's to Barry's and got him going again.

oh Well, I will leave the racing story to someone else.

When we were leaving Steve and Helen in the 100/6 Steve raced gave Pat and I a lift over to his Van and trailer with me on the shroud in front of Steve. On the way over I could see a big 44 gallon drum garbage tin looming up I'm saying to Steve to S+ p! & WhoA! and Helen is telling him the same he did stop just as we started to climb the drum. Then we proceeded to put the car on the trailer with me guiding him on & Pat behind when all of a sudden Pat went red in the face and starting shouting for me. So I went around the Healey and there was Pat holding up the rear end of the Healey it had kicked both boards so then there was Pat & I And Steve holding the healey up. Holy Suffering Hernias anyway we finally got it on. O boy want drama. We finally got home where I finally finished Pats

continued...





TRIPING SOUTH, THEN BACK NORTH, AND WHAT HEPPENED IN BETWEEN continued.

car then we got ready for the party at Steve's which went off really well. Saw lots of people we don't always see. It was real grouse. Finally crawled into bed at about 2 o'clock this time with Chris Gray staying at Steve's place as well. Steve dragged us out of bed, we had breakfast packed the car and headed back to Sydney this time by the Hume Highway, which everyone reckoned was Okay and better than the Olympic Highway boy what a lot of garbage it was even worse than usual if that is possible. We came across Helen & Larry having a little trouble with the 3A but a few well placed hits by Larry fixed it. Then off we went again. We arrived at Wodonga at about 12 o'clock we had been on the road for 3 hours and not one thing went wrong. The 1004 was running beautiful, we had lunch, this time no steak sandwiches only a few hamburgers. At this time Abe, Chris, Don And Anne pulled up in the "green bean" for lunch too. We finished lunch and actually survived it. Fueled up and were off again. Talk about a goat track we near disappearde down some of the holes. Then it started to rain. It came in the bottom of the doors, the top of the doors, under the dash everywhere but on top of us. Oh well on my side anyway. Pat reckoned his side was Okay and he couldn't understand why it was coming in around the doors & I tried to tell him when there is no trim this does tend to happen. Even in the best of Cars. So in a 1004 it would have to heppen.

Larry gave Pat a bit of a run. But he started to pull away so far, in the big 6 cylinder 3A that he had to slow down so Pat could catch up and not feel to shattered. I tried to console him by saying well it has got 6 cylinders Pat what chance have you got. But he kept on mumbling and was quite adamant that Larry wouldn't have pulled away if he didn't have to slow down for a bump. Poor mixed up Lad. Maybe when he gets his BN3 six powered hybrid going on the road he might get the feeling of real power. Even if he will have the same surroundings and not the superior interior a 6 cylinder. Anyway enough of this biassed garbage,

Finally we arrived at Yass where Pat stopped to fuel up and I also stopped to fuel up (a bit hungry). When Pat saw what I had bought he thought he was running a greyhound bus to West Australia also at this stop I put on my plastic trousers to protect me from getting a cold numb bum by the cascades of water precipitating on me from assorted nooks and grannies. Here again, the "green bean" this time with Don at the wheel pulled in and the two girls went for a quick sprint somewhere. Anyway they came back with much relieved faces then we push started the bean and we were on our way again. Here on it was a trouble free trip. Except for the rough road and rain, We pulled into my abode about 9.00 which was pretty good, for such a

continued...





TRIPPINGSOUTH. THEN BACK NORTH, AND WHAT HAPPENED IN BETWEEN continued.

lousy trip. We had coffee, Pat commented on the fact that it would take weeks to clean his car (I think there was a hint there somewhere) then off into the midnight he went and I collapsed in bed.

It was a grouse weekend with all people who went enjoying themselves. It was really great to see so many people all tossing in and working to make it a great team effort, and with people like this in the club it is no wonder we are going ahead in leaps and bounds.

Healeying forever,  
(P.S. even if it is as a passenger in a 100/4)

Dennis Wraight.

\* \* \*

#### AWARDS

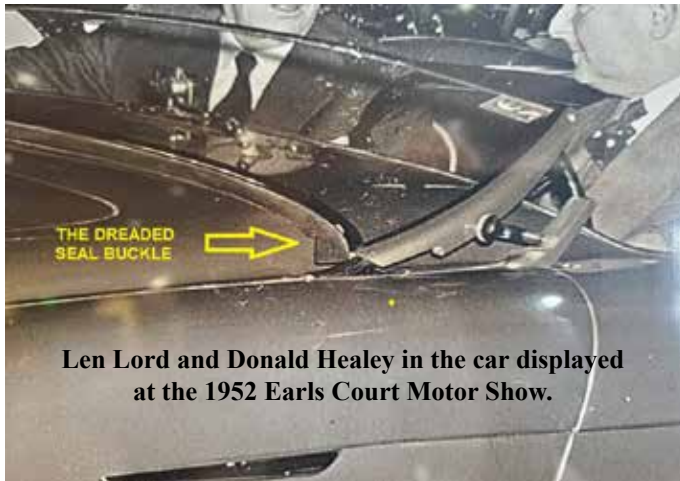
|                    |                       |
|--------------------|-----------------------|
| Great Effort       | - Chris Gray          |
| Blower Upperer     | - Ben "Tubby" Sellers |
| Toyota Spare Parts | - Wally Gates         |
| Ventilation        | - Barry Birch         |
| Womens Choice      | - Adrian Hart         |
| Pensmanship        | - Kev "Abe" Gardner   |
| Greasy Overalls    | - Ian Russell         |
| Rudolph Red Nose   | - Ian "Skins" Thomson |
| Baa'. Baa!         | - Heather Bennett     |
| Fungus Features    | - Rod Bennett         |
| Swinger            | - Fran Russell        |
| Swarthy Gentleman  | - Pat Quinn           |
| Best Red Head      | - John Watson         |

Dennis Wraight

## Austin-Healey 100 Windshield Seal Buckling

By Michael Salter - <https://precisionsportscar.com/>

Displayed in the lobby at Enclave 2022 in the US were some enlargements of photographs of Len Lord and Donald Healey at the 1952 Earls Court Motor Show taken, reputedly, shortly after they had consummated the deal for the Healey 100 to be manufactured by The Austin Motor Company as the Austin-Healey 100.



These were wonderful historic photos but what particularly caught my eye was the rubber seal between the fold down windshield and the body of that first car. The fit of the seal was dreadful!



This particular detail has been the nemesis of many Austin Healey 100 restorers because, with the curves near the ends of the lower section of the windshield frame, it is very difficult to eliminate the “buckle” of the seal at its outer ends.

The upper edge of this seal, like many others on convertibles of the day, is “T” shaped and the top of that “T” slides into a channel on the lower edge of the chromed brass frame. The problem is that when the upper edge of the seal is inserted into the channel

the lower edge gets crumpled up near the ends and buckles just like the ones in the famous photographs.

Well, there is a restorer’s trick which can be used to eliminate that buckling.

Once it is correctly inserted into the channel gently stretching the outer 6 inches or so of the upper edge of the seal, the area which is inserted inside the channel, will eliminate the buckling. This process requires a little finesse to avoid pulling the seal out of the channel on the inside of the curve but, when done correctly, this stretching will eliminate the buckling completely however, when the tension is released, the seal will slide back along the channel to its normal length and the buckle will return.

Having examined quite a number of these windshield frames I have observed that the outer ends of the lower seal channel are almost always punched down slightly and that is the key.

Punching down the channel whilst the seal is in its stretched condition prevents the seal from retracting to its natural length and the buckling is permanently eliminated.



I’m not a big fan of punching down the channel as brass has a tendency to crack fairly easily when bent so I just put a couple of drops of Crazy Glue onto the seal then temporally clamp it to prevent it from retracting.

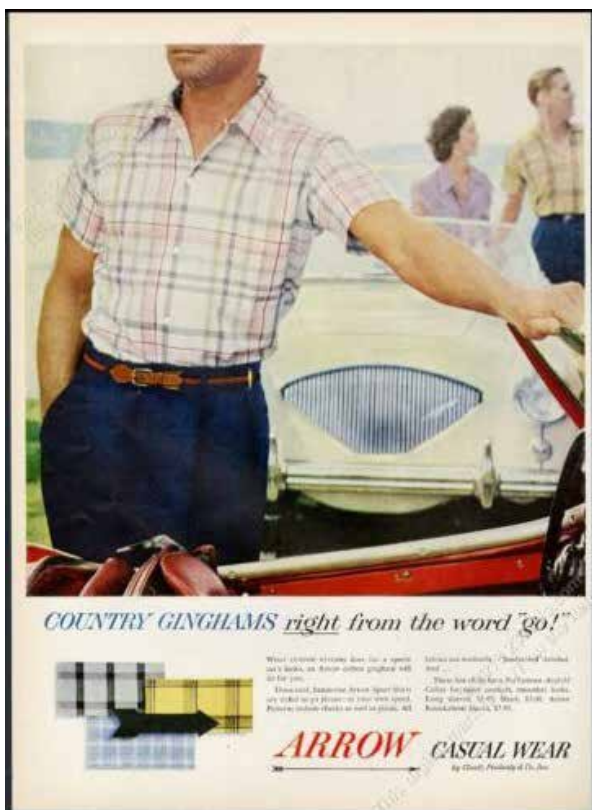


## Your Last Page



Spot the Austin-Healey. The Gold Coast in 1959.  
This one is easy

Jensen C-V8s being assembled  
alongside 3000 Mk3s



Wonder if it was a free shirt with every Austin-Healey 100 sold.



Reminds me of my first 100

## Monthly Meetings

We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club  
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm